

“VIETNAM WAS LOST IN THE LIVING ROOMS OF AMERICA, NOT ON THE BATTLEFIELDS OF VIETNAM.”

Marshall McLuhan, media commentator, writing at the end of the Vietnam War

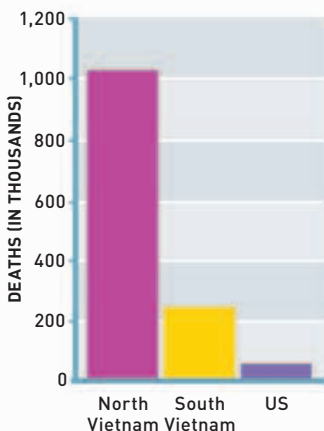
MARGARET THATCHER BECAME THE FIRST WOMAN to lead a political party in Britain on February 11, when she won the Conservative Party vote.

In the Middle East, Saudi Arabia's **King Faisal** (1906–75) was **assassinated** by his nephew, Prince Faisal Ibu Musaed.

Prince Juan Carlos was sworn in as King of Spain, two days after dictator General Francisco Franco died on November 20.

In April, the Cambodian capital, **Phnom Penh**, fell to the radical communist movement, the **Khmer Rouge**, led by **Pol Pot**. They transformed Cambodia into a communist, rural society. All inhabitants of cities were expelled to work in agricultural communes.

After almost two decades of fighting, the **Vietnam War** finally



Vietnamese war casualties

More than one million North Vietnamese troops died, compared to around 220,000 from South Vietnam, and 58,000 from the US.



Fall of Saigon

The North Vietnam troops (pictured) met little resistance in Saigon, but the final hours of America's presence were marked by chaos.

ended on April 30 as the government in Saigon surrendered to the **North Vietnam** forces. Saigon was renamed **Ho Chi Minh City** and the following year, North and South Vietnam were reunified.

Mozambique became **independent** on June 25, after a coup in Portugal ended colonial rule (see 1974). Four months later, **Angola** also gained its independence (see 1976).

Iraq stepped up its military pressure against **Kurdish rebels** in northern Iraq. The **Kurds** were **crushed** with the razing of Zakho and Qala Diza.

In **Lebanon**, Christian militia attacked a bus full of Palestinians in

Beirut. This started a **civil war** that lasted for 15 years (see 1990).

This was a year of global terrorism, as **Arab terrorists** held **hostages** at Orly airport in Paris; a German left-wing group seized the **German Embassy** in Stockholm, Sweden; and South Moluccan terrorists took over the **Indonesian Embassy** in Amsterdam, the Netherlands.

In November, **oil** began to flow from the **North Sea** from sources that British Petroleum (BP) discovered six years earlier.

Microsoft was officially founded on April 4 by **Bill Gates** (b. 1955) and **Paul Allen** (b. 1953), starting the world of personal computing.

US Purple Heart

A US military decoration awarded to the wounded or killed, 351,794 Purple Hearts were awarded during the Vietnam War.



Two punks kiss on the Kings Road in London. Punk rock emerged during the mid-70's as an angry expression of contempt for politics and society.

THE MARXIST PEOPLE'S MOVEMENT FOR THE LIBERATION OF ANGOLA

(MPLA) took nominal control of the whole country by February, and the new **Angola People's Republic** was recognized. This was preceded by intense fighting that also involved the National Front for the Liberation of Angola (FNLA) and the Union for the Total Independence of Angola (UNITA).

Antipartheid protests in Soweto, **South Africa** turned violent on June 16. Demonstrators clashed with police and more than 300 people were killed.

THE ARCHBISHOP OF UGANDA, DR. JANANI LUWUM (b. 1922), was murdered on February 16 for being an Anglican, and for protesting against the excesses of **Idi Amin's regime** (see 1971).

Steven Biko (see panel, right), a prominent black rights leader in South Africa, **died in prison** on September 12. He had been detained under the terrorism act. His death caused **international outrage** but an inquest cleared the police of any wrongdoing.

In Pakistan, Zulfikar Ali Bhutto's **Pakistan People's Party (PPP)** was accused of **vote rigging**. This prompted Army Chief General Mohammed Zia ul-Haq to depose Bhutto in a **military coup** on July 4.

The right-wing **Menachem Begin** (1913–92) had a surprise win at the Israeli elections in May, ending 29 years of Labor rule. As premier, he initiated a **peace process** with Egypt (see 1979).

40–70 MILLION THE NUMBER OF DEATHS CAUSED BY MAO'S REGIME

Mao Zedong (b. 1893), the founder of the People's Republic of China, died of a heart attack on September 9.

Syrian peacekeeping troops entered **Lebanon** on 9 June. In December, after more than 50 ceasefires had been violated, uneasy peace prevailed.

The **Seychelles** gained **independence** from Britain on June 29, with James Mancham as president and France Rene as prime minister of the coalition.



Fruit of knowledge

Apple Inc. computers went on sale this year. The distinctive logo—a rainbow-colored apple with a bite taken out—symbolized knowledge.

